would go a long way toward improving U.S.-Soviet relations: He could end the shipment of Soviet military weapons to Nicaragua.

As we walked across the White House lawn under gray, threatening clouds that later turned to rain, Gorbachev told me he would do that.

Forty minutes behind schedule, the summit came to an end as Nancy and I said good-bye to the Gorbachevs under a light rain. “Well, at last it’s over,” I wrote in the diary that night. “They’ve departed and I think the whole thing was the best summit we’ve ever had with the Soviet Union.”